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ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

Amaravathi Road, Gorantla, Guntur-34, Andhra Pradesh, India.



Website: www.stannscollegeforwomen.ac.in

EQUAL OPPORTUNITY CELL / SC-ST / MINORITY CELL

ANNUAL ACTIVITY REPORT

ACADEMIC YEAR 2024–2025

1. INTRODUCTION

The Equal Opportunity Cell (EOC) / SC-ST / Minority Cell of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur, functions with the primary objective of promoting equal opportunity, equity, inclusiveness, social justice and holistic development among students.

The Cell works to ensure that students belonging to Scheduled Castes (SC), Scheduled Tribes (ST), Minority communities and other socially and economically disadvantaged sections have equitable access to educational opportunities, scholarships, academic support, counselling, skill development and other institutional facilities.

During the academic year 2024–2025, the Cell organized and supported various awareness, sensitization, scholarship facilitation, mentoring, career guidance and student empowerment activities in coordination with the IQAC, academic departments and other student support cells of the institution.

2. OBJECTIVES OF THE CELL

The major objectives of the EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell were:

1. To promote equal educational opportunities for all students.
2. To create awareness about equality, social justice and non-discrimination.
3. To facilitate access to Government scholarships and welfare schemes.
4. To provide guidance and support to students belonging to disadvantaged communities.
5. To identify students requiring academic, financial or personal assistance.
6. To encourage equal participation in academic, cultural, sports and extension activities.
7. To provide awareness regarding higher education and career opportunities.
8. To promote confidence, leadership, communication and employability skills.

9. To coordinate with institutional support mechanisms for timely student assistance.

10. To promote an inclusive, safe, respectful and harmonious campus environment.

3. ACTIVITIES CONDUCTED DURING THE ACADEMIC YEAR 2024–2025

3.1 Orientation and Awareness on Equal Opportunity and Student Support

Date: July 2024

Organised by: EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell

An awareness and orientation programme was conducted to familiarize students with the functions of the Equal Opportunity Cell and the various student support mechanisms available in the institution.

Students were sensitized regarding:

- Equal educational opportunities
- Non-discrimination
- Social inclusion
- Scholarship facilities
- Student counselling
- Mentor–Mentee support
- Grievance Redressal Mechanism
- Anti-Ragging measures
- Career and skill-development opportunities

Outcome:

Students became aware of the institutional support systems and the avenues available to seek assistance whenever required.

3.2 Scholarship Awareness and Facilitation

Period: July–November 2024

The Cell facilitated awareness regarding various **Government scholarship and welfare schemes** available to eligible students.

The activity included:

- Identification of eligible students

- Awareness regarding available scholarship schemes
- Guidance on online applications
- Assistance with required documents
- Verification and follow-up
- Guidance regarding scholarship-related queries

The Cell coordinated with the concerned institutional offices and authorities wherever necessary.

Outcome:

Eligible students were provided with information and guidance to access available financial assistance.

3.3 Awareness Programme on Equality, Social Justice and Constitutional Values

Date: August 2024

Organised by: EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell

An awareness programme was conducted to sensitize students to the principles of equality, social justice, dignity, fraternity and respect for diversity.

The programme highlighted:

- Equality and dignity
- Constitutional values
- Social justice
- Fundamental rights and duties
- Respect for diversity
- Non-discrimination
- Responsible citizenship

Outcome:

Students developed greater awareness of the importance of equality, social justice and harmonious coexistence.

3.4 Constitution Day Observance

Date: 26 November 2024

In collaboration with: IQAC / Academic Departments

The institution observed **Constitution Day** to create awareness among students about the Constitution and its fundamental values.

Students were sensitized to the principles of **justice, liberty, equality and fraternity** and their importance in building a responsible and inclusive society.

Outcome:

The programme strengthened awareness of constitutional values and responsible citizenship among students.

3.5 Academic Mentoring and Support

Period: Throughout the Academic Year 2024–2025

The Cell worked in coordination with the **Mentor–Mentee System and academic departments** to provide support to students requiring additional academic guidance.

The mentoring process included:

- Monitoring academic progress
- Encouraging regular attendance
- Guidance for examination preparation
- Study-skills support
- Time-management guidance
- Identification of learning difficulties
- Referral to appropriate academic support

Outcome:

Students requiring additional support were identified and guided through the appropriate institutional mechanisms.

3.6 Career Guidance and Higher Education Awareness

Date: January 2025

Organised in collaboration with: Training & Placement / Career Guidance initiatives

A career and higher education awareness programme was conducted to help students understand opportunities available after graduation.

The programme covered:

- Higher education opportunities
- Competitive examinations
- Employment opportunities
- Skill-development programmes
- Internships
- Placement opportunities
- Entrepreneurship
- Career planning

Outcome:

Students gained awareness of different career pathways and were encouraged to make informed decisions regarding higher education and employment.

3.7 Capacity Building and Employability Skills

Date: February 2025

A capacity-building activity was conducted to enhance students' confidence and employability.

The programme focused on:

- Communication skills
- Digital literacy
- Resume preparation
- Interview skills
- Group discussion
- Leadership
- Workplace etiquette
- Self-confidence

Outcome:

Students developed greater confidence and awareness of the skills required for higher education and employment.

3.8 Human Rights, Dignity and Non-Discrimination Awareness

Date: December 2024

A sensitization programme was conducted on **human dignity, equality, human rights and non-discrimination**.

Students were encouraged to:

- Respect individual dignity
- Promote equality
- Avoid discriminatory practices
- Respect diversity
- Maintain social harmony
- Support an inclusive campus environment

Outcome:

The programme promoted mutual respect, tolerance and a culture of inclusion among students.

3.9 Women's Empowerment and Leadership Development

Date: March 2025

In collaboration with: Women Empowerment Cell

As a women's institution, the Cell supported initiatives aimed at strengthening the confidence and leadership abilities of students, particularly those requiring additional social and educational support.

The activity focused on:

- Self-confidence
- Leadership skills
- Decision-making
- Career planning
- Financial awareness

- Digital empowerment
- Entrepreneurship
- Personal development

Outcome:

Students were encouraged to develop leadership qualities, confidence and greater awareness of educational and career opportunities.

3.10 Inclusive Participation in Institutional Activities

Period: Throughout the Academic Year 2024–2025

The Cell encouraged students from SC/ST/Minority and other disadvantaged backgrounds to participate actively in various institutional programmes.

Students were encouraged to participate in:

- Academic seminars and workshops
- Cultural activities
- Sports and games
- NSS and NCC activities
- Extension and outreach programmes
- Competitions
- Skill-development programmes
- Career and placement activities
- Co-curricular and extracurricular activities

Outcome:

The initiative promoted equal participation and provided students with opportunities for holistic development.

4. STUDENT SUPPORT AND FACILITATION

During the academic year, the Cell provided guidance and facilitated support in the following areas:

- Scholarship and welfare schemes
- Academic mentoring

- Counselling and personal support
- Career guidance
- Skill development
- Higher education opportunities
- Grievance support
- Participation in institutional activities
- Access to available student support services

Students requiring specialized assistance were guided to the appropriate institutional committee or support service.

5. COLLABORATION WITH OTHER INSTITUTIONAL CELLS

The EOC / SC-ST / Minority Cell worked in coordination with:

- **IQAC**
- **Women Empowerment Cell**
- **Student Counselling Cell**
- **Mentor–Mentee System**
- **Grievance Redressal Cell**
- **Anti-Ragging Committee**
- **NSS**
- **NCC**
- **Training & Placement Cell**
- **Career Guidance initiatives**
- **Academic Departments**

Such coordination helped in providing integrated support and ensuring equal participation of students in institutional activities.

6. MAJOR OUTCOMES

The activities conducted during the academic year 2024–2025 contributed to:

1. Increased awareness of equal educational opportunities.

2. Improved awareness of scholarship and welfare schemes.
3. Greater understanding of constitutional values and social justice.
4. Promotion of a non-discriminatory and inclusive campus environment.
5. Strengthened academic mentoring and student support.
6. Increased awareness of higher education and career opportunities.
7. Development of communication, confidence and employability skills.
8. Encouragement of participation in academic and co-curricular activities.
9. Strengthened coordination among various student support mechanisms.
10. Promotion of dignity, equality, social harmony and responsible citizenship.

7. CONCLUSION

The Equal Opportunity Cell / SC-ST / Minority Cell of St. Ann's College for Women continued its efforts during the academic year 2024–2025 to promote equity, inclusion, social justice and equal opportunities for all students.

Through awareness programmes, scholarship facilitation, academic mentoring, career guidance, capacity-building initiatives and collaboration with various institutional support mechanisms, the Cell contributed to the holistic development and educational empowerment of students.

The Cell remains committed to strengthening an inclusive, equitable, supportive and discrimination-free educational environment, in keeping with the vision, mission and values of St. Ann's College for Women.

Submitted to

The Principal

St. Ann's College for Women
Gorantla, Guntur, Andhra Pradesh

Submitted by

Coordinator

Equal Opportunity Cell / SC-ST / Minority Cell

Academic Year

2024–2025